



Gender Cell

End-Term Report (2025-26)



1. Introduction

The Gender Cell of IIT Kanpur is an institutional body dedicated to creating a safe, inclusive, and gender-sensitive environment for everyone on campus. Its goal is to promote awareness about gender equality, prevent sexual harassment and discrimination, and support individuals who may be affected by such issues.

This end-term report provides an overview of the Gender Cell's work during the past tenure (2025-26). It highlights the initiatives taken to spread awareness, the activities conducted, how internal meetings were organized, and the future plans proposed by the current team.

2. Student Nominees (2025-26)

- Rasagna Abothula (UG Female Nominee)
- Pushpender (UG Male Nominee)
- Jyoti Srivastava (PG Female Nominee)

3. Message from Student Nominees

Throughout the year, the Gender Cell nominees made sustained efforts to enhance the visibility, accessibility, and approachability of the cell across the campus. This was achieved through a range of events and awareness initiatives aimed at encouraging dialogue and promoting a gender-sensitive environment. We received consistent guidance and support from faculty members, as well as from our dedicated staff member, Mrs. Pragati Indoria Ma'am, whose involvement was invaluable to our functioning.

During our tenure, the Gender Cell addressed multiple cases related to sexual harassment, gender discrimination, and inequality. In each instance, efforts were made to provide appropriate guidance, ensure confidentiality, and extend all possible support to individuals who approached the cell, while following due processes.

An important observation during this period was the variation in participation across different types of events. Sensitization sessions and discussion-based initiatives, such as open mics, witnessed relatively lower engagement from the campus community. In contrast, informal and activity-based events, including tote bag painting and run/walk events, saw significantly higher participation. This highlights a gap in engagement with more serious or discussion-oriented spaces and suggests the need to rethink and redesign sensitization efforts in ways that are more interactive, approachable, and effective in raising awareness about gender-related issues.

4. Events and Initiatives (Month Wise)

2025, June

- A post for Pride Month was shared on instagram and facebook to promote inclusivity, acceptance, and support for the LGBTQ+ community.
- Movie screening of Shubh Mangal Zyada Saavdhan was organized, with participation of over 70 students, to encourage dialogue on representation, relationships, and inclusion.
- A Secretary Recruitment Drive was conducted, through which approximately 20 secretaries were recruited to strengthen the planning, execution, and outreach of Gender Cell initiatives.

2025, July

- A creative post titled Words of Pride: Echoes of Courage was posted, highlighting themes of identity, struggle, and resilience within the LGBTQ+ community.
- A Gender Cell Orientation session was conducted for over 200 Student Guides (2025–26), focusing on inclusivity, empathy, and the creation of safe spaces for incoming students.
- An orientation session for the 2025 freshers batch was conducted, reaching over 2200 students and covering gender sensitization, institutional policies, consent, and complaint mechanisms.

2025, August

- A monthly blog series titled “Towards a Safer Space” was launched, focusing on topics such as consent, inclusivity, respectful behavior, and building a safer campus culture.
- Gender Awareness Test was conducted for over 2000 freshers to assess their understanding of gender sensitivity, consent, institutional policies, and respectful conduct.
- An Independence Day digital awareness initiative, combined with the Voice for Equality campaign, was undertaken to promote unity, equality, and freedom from discrimination.

- An Open Mic event was organized as an interactive platform for students to express their perspectives on gender, consent, and safety through creative mediums.
- Gender Cell posters across the campus were updated with revised information, helplines, and awareness messages to improve accessibility and visibility.
- An advisory video on gender sensitization was developed to serve as an accessible educational resource for the campus community.

2025, September

- Cyber Awareness Digital Campaign was conducted to address cyberbullying and online harassment through informative content and safety guidelines.
- Movie screening of *Stree 2* was organized, followed by informal discussions encouraging reflection on women's safety, societal roles, and allyship.

2025, October

- Dedicated task forces were constituted for Udghosh and Antaragni in collaboration with festival security teams to ensure a safe and harassment-free environment. Members were trained to handle complaints sensitively and respond effectively.
- A sensitization session was conducted at Opportunity School, focusing on respect, empathy, personal boundaries, and equality through interactive engagement.
- A poetry competition titled Goonj: Echoes Unheard was organized, providing participants a platform to express perspectives on gender, identity, and social justice.
- A sensitization session by Prof. Priyanka Bagade was conducted for Gender Cell secretaries to orient them regarding their roles, responsibilities, and expectations.
- Structured course modules and a comprehensive awareness video were developed, covering topics such as gender sensitization, sexual harassment, consent, relevant laws and policies, cyber harassment, and building a respectful campus environment.

2025, December

- The SIS Sensitization Program was conducted in multiple slots to promote awareness on gender sensitivity, respectful communication, and inclusive practices.
- A month-long digital campaign on women's empowerment and rights was organized, highlighting issues related to equality, safety, and socio-economic participation.

- A reel contest on positive masculinity was conducted to challenge stereotypes and encourage more inclusive perspectives.

2026, January

- New Year and Republic Day posts were shared to promote inclusivity, equality, and constitutional values such as justice and dignity.
- The Gen-der Quiz was conducted in collaboration with the Quiz Club to engage students in topics related to gender awareness and societal norms.
- A PYRAS sensitization session was conducted for children, focusing on personal safety, consent, and healthy boundaries through age-appropriate methods.
- A creative event titled Paint the Tote Bag – Paint Your Voice was organized, encouraging participants to express their views on gender equality and identity through art.
- A winter orientation session was conducted for freshers, introducing key concepts of gender sensitization, institutional policies, and available support systems.

2026, March

- Women's Day movie screening (Haq) was organized along with a social media campaign celebrating women's achievements and promoting gender equality.
- The 5KM Run & Walk (8th Edition), a flagship event, was conducted with participation of over 900 individuals under the theme "It's Not the Intent, It's the Impact that Matters," aiming to promote awareness and collective responsibility.
- The official Gender Cell website was updated to improve accessibility, structure, and information flow. New features, including a direct call option and notification system, were introduced to enhance support access. The updated website is available at: <https://iitk.ac.in/gc/>.
- A weekly "Myth & Fact" series was launched to address common misconceptions related to gender issues. Each post aimed to debunk prevalent myths through factual information, thereby promoting critical thinking and encouraging informed discussions within the campus community.
- A creative reel titled "Tough Enough" was developed, featuring a poem that highlighted gender stereotypes affecting both men and women. The initiative aimed to encourage reflection on societal expectations and promote a more inclusive understanding of identity and self-expression.

5. Recommendations for Next Tenure

1. A dedicated **Cyber Security Cell** should be established to effectively address cases of cyber sexual harassment. During our tenure, **a significant proportion of complaints were related to online platforms**. In several instances, appropriate action could not be taken due to the absence of a structured mechanism to handle such cases. This highlights the need for a dedicated system to address cyber-related complaints, which are often complex and underreported.
2. It has been observed that in several instances, when cases are referred to the ICC, they are not formally recorded as complaints. **It is recommended that all cases be formally documented at the point of reporting in ICC, even if they are later dismissed or referred to another body.** Maintaining such records would ensure accurate reflection of the number and nature of cases and improve transparency and accountability in the system.
3. **Accessibility to ICC processes** should be improved by keeping complaint forms easily accessible and regularly publishing anonymized data on reported, resolved, retracted, and ongoing cases.
4. Efforts should be made to **actively promote inclusion and support for the LGBTQ+ community on campus** through regular awareness campaigns, sensitization sessions, and inclusive events.
5. Prominent **advisory boards against sexual harassment** should be installed across the campus to improve visibility and awareness, similar to initiatives implemented at IIT Delhi.
6. A dedicated **breastfeeding area** should be established in or near the academic zone to support nursing mothers and promote inclusive infrastructure.
7. **Anti-drug measures** across the campus should be strengthened, as increasing substance use has been associated with unsafe environments and a rise in cases of sexual harassment.
8. **Social media** outreach should be expanded **in collaboration with IMOC** to ensure wider dissemination of information, campaigns, and awareness content.
9. **Periodic meetings between the Gender Cell and ICC members** should be conducted to review cases, share updates, and improve response mechanisms.
10. **Formal institutional email IDs for nominees** (e.g., gendercell_nominee@iitk.ac.in) should be created to streamline official communication, data management, and access permissions. At present, important information such as complaints, budget-related documents, and permissions is often received and stored in personal email accounts of nominees, which leads to loss of continuity and records across tenures. A centralized institutional email system would ensure better record-keeping, data security, and smoother transitions between teams.

11. **A designated room should be allocated for the Gender Cell** to improve accessibility, coordination, and overall operational efficiency. The Cell regularly conducts events that require purchase of materials; however, in the absence of a dedicated storage space, these items cannot be retained and often need to be repurchased in subsequent tenures. Additionally, regular meetings among nominees (held approximately twice a month), secretary meetings, and interview processes face logistical challenges due to the lack of a fixed space. Providing a dedicated room would address these issues by enabling proper storage, smoother coordination, and more efficient functioning of the Cell.

6. Final Note

Serving as Gender Cell nominees has been a deeply enriching experience and a privilege for all of us. Throughout our tenure, we worked to sensitize the campus community and extend support to individuals affected by gender discrimination and sexual harassment. We made consistent efforts to ensure that the Gender Cell remained visible, approachable, and accessible to every member of the campus community and beyond.